

The GenZ Times

Where Generations Connect.

For
Dreamers
Thinkers
Doers

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Explore paths, possibilities
and purpose in the world of
change

NEXT GEN LEADERS

Stories of young
change makers who
are making an impact

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Future-ready skills to
learn, relearn and
level-up

MINDS THAT INSPIRE

Idea, Innovations &
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Voices

AI AND YOU
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VOICES

From the Chairperson & the Editor

Two people open every issue of this magazine. One carries the vision. The other carries the words.

CHAIRPERSON'S MESSAGE • PRATHYUSHA PRABHALA



Prathyusha Prabhala, Chief Content Officer & Chairperson.

Dear Students, Parents, Teachers and Education Leaders - welcome to the inaugural issue of The GenZ Times. At Saaradaa Learknowations Pvt. Ltd., we believe education is about inspiring curiosity, building character and preparing learners for the future, not just achieving academic success.

This magazine was created to go beyond textbooks by fostering awareness, critical thinking, innovation, career guidance and lifelong learning. Our promise remains simple: many publish books; we build futures.

We dedicate this issue to teachers, whose guidance shapes every profession and every generation. We also extend our heartfelt gratitude to the schools, principals, educators, students and parents who supported this journey. The GenZ Times is your platform - share your ideas, research and experiences with us. Together, let us nurture informed minds, compassionate leaders and responsible citizens who will shape a stronger tomorrow.

- Prathyusha Prabhala, on behalf of Saaradaa Learknowations Pvt. Ltd.

"We did not build this magazine to predict the future. We built it to help a generation choose one."

THE EDITORS

EDITOR'S VOICE • RAMESH MAMIDALA



Ramesh Mamidala, Editor-in-Chief.

There has never been a more exciting - or more challenging - time to be a learner. As artificial intelligence transforms education and careers evolve rapidly, learners need more than knowledge; they need curiosity, critical thinking, creativity and ethical leadership.

The GenZ Times was created to explore these changing realities and inspire meaningful conversations. This inaugural issue focuses on artificial intelligence, Generation Z, the future of learning, emerging careers and the evolving role of teachers. Rather than simply providing information, we aim to encourage reflection, dialogue and fresh perspectives.

This magazine is also a platform for your ideas, research, opinions and experiences. We invite you to challenge, contribute and grow with us. Together, let us shape an education system that

prepares learners not just for exams, but for life.

- Ramesh Mamidala, Editor-in-Chief, The GenZ Times

A SHARED PROMISE

Between the vision and the words sits a single conviction both of us hold: that a magazine, like a classroom, earns its readers rather than assuming them. If we have managed it, you will disagree with us somewhere in these sixty-four pages, and you will write to tell us so. That is not a failure of the magazine; it is the whole point of it. A publication that only prints what its readers already believe is a mirror. We would rather be a window.

WRITE TO US

- Letters & essays - editor@saaradaa.com (keep letters under 150 words)
- The GenZ Times is your platform. Reflect, argue and write to us - see page 63.
- www.theslpl.in | store.theslpl.in

Are We Turning Around?

Artificial intelligence has already entered the Indian classroom. The only question left is whether we are steering it - or being steered by it.

BY THE GENZ TIMES EDITORIAL DESK

Classrooms across India are quietly rewiring themselves. In a Hyderabad secondary school, a Class IX student finishes a chemistry worksheet, photographs it, and asks a chatbot to explain the two answers she got wrong. She has a response in eleven seconds. Her teacher, three desks away, is using the same technology to build next week's lesson plan in a quarter of the time it once took.

Neither of them thinks this is remarkable. That, more than any statistic, is the measure of how far the ground has moved. Two years ago, generative AI in an Indian classroom was a novelty demonstrated at a conference. Today it is infrastructure - as unremarkable as the blackboard behind it.

THE NUMBERS BEHIND THE SHIFT

The scale of adoption is genuinely startling. Surveys through 2025 and 2026 put the share of Indian students who have used an AI tool for study at roughly 86 per cent. About seven in ten teachers now report using AI to plan lessons, draft assessments or generate practice questions. The Government of India declared 2025 its Year of AI, and from the 2026-27 session an AI curriculum begins in schools from Grade 3 upward.



The defining image of a generation: the human hand and the machine, reaching for the same problem.

And yet, buried in the same surveys, is a figure that ought to stop us. Only about three per cent of Indian institu-

tions have deeply integrated AI into how they actually teach. Adoption has raced far ahead of integration. Students and teachers are using these tools individually, privately and largely without guidance, while the institutions around them have barely begun to think about what it means.

"The question is no longer whether AI enters the classroom. It already has. The question is whether anyone is steering it."

GENZ TIMES EDITORIAL

That gap is where the danger lives. A tool adopted without a pedagogy is not neutral; it fills the vacuum with its own logic. And the logic of a chatbot, left unsupervised, is to give the student what they asked for, as fast as possible.

WHAT WE GAIN

Begin with the honest case for optimism, because it is strong. The most expensive thing in education has always been individual attention, and AI has made a version of it very nearly free. A child who cannot follow quadratic equations can now ask the same question five different ways, at eleven at night, without embarrassment - and be answered patiently every time.

For teachers, the gain is time. The hours once lost to grading and worksheet-making can be reinvested in the one thing no machine does: noticing. Noticing the child who has stopped putting her hand up. Noticing the bright student who has quietly stopped trying.

WHAT WE RISK

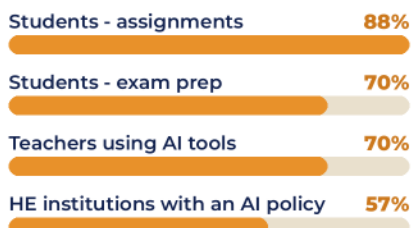
The risk is subtler than cheating, and considerably worse. Learning requires what psychologists call desirable difficulty - the productive struggle in which understanding is actually constructed. An answer arriving in eleven seconds removes precisely that struggle. The student feels fluent. The student is not. And because the feeling of fluency is almost indistinguishable from the fact of it, nobody notices until an examination hall makes it brutally clear.

THE BIG QUESTION

- Are we teaching students to think WITH AI, or to outsource thinking TO it?
- Adoption is not integration. A tool without a pedagogy fills the vacuum with its own logic.
- The difference will decide the next decade of Indian education.

Adoption has outrun integration

Reported use across Indian education, 2025



Source: Indian student AI survey 2025 (n=136); CENTA

ANALYSIS

Why Foundations Matter

You cannot build a competitive-exam career on a cracked foundation. NEP 2020 says the same thing in policy language. Here is the human version.

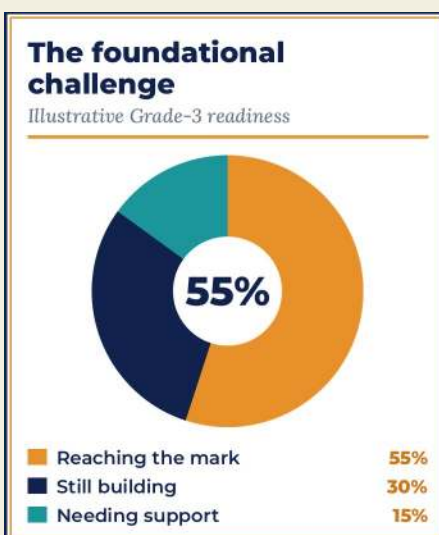
BY THE GENZ TIMES EDITORIAL DESK

Every dazzling outcome in Indian education - an IIT seat, a civil-services rank, a research fellowship, a first job abroad - rests on two quiet skills acquired before the age of eight. The ability to read a paragraph and know what it said. The ability to look at a number and know what it means. Everything else is built on top of these two, and nothing can compensate for their absence.

This is not a sentimental claim. It is arithmetic. A child who reaches Class VI reading at a Class II level does not have a reading problem; she has a science problem, a mathematics problem and a history problem, because every one of those subjects is delivered to her in written words she cannot decode fast enough to think about.

THE MISSION WITH A DEADLINE

NIPUN Bharat, launched in 2021 under NEP 2020, is the government's response. Its target is unambiguous: universal foundational literacy and numeracy by the end of Grade 3, with eighty per cent of children in every school reaching the mark by 2026-27. It is the rarest thing in Indian policy - a promise with a number and a date attached.



The foundational challenge: only about a quarter of Std III children can read a Grade-2 text (ASER 2024).

What makes the target hard is not the teaching. It is the catching up. A classroom of forty children in Class III will contain some who read fluently and some who cannot sound out their own name, and the teacher is expected to move all of them through the same syllabus at the same speed. The syllabus wins. The children do not.

SYSTEM ENHANCEMENT VERSUS PEOPLE ENHANCEMENT

There is a fashionable belief that technology solves this. It does not, and the distinction matters. Technology enhances the system: it gives us dashboards, content libraries, adaptive practice and analytics that tell us precisely which child is behind and by how much. These are real gains and we should take them.

But only people enhance people. A child learns to love reading from a human being who visibly loves reading. A child learns that being wrong is survivable from an adult who was gentle the first time she was wrong. No dashboard has ever done this, and none

ever will, because the thing being transmitted is not information.

“The smartest classroom in the world still needs a teacher who notices the quiet student in the third row.”

GENZ TIMES EDITORIAL

WHAT A FOUNDATION ACTUALLY IS

Ask most parents what a strong foundation means and they will describe marks. Ask a teacher and you will get a different, better answer: a child who can sit with a hard thing for twenty minutes without panicking. That capacity - call it cognitive stamina - is the true foundation, and it is built in the early years or not at all.

It is also, uncomfortably, the capacity most at risk in the age of the instant answer. A generation that can retrieve any fact in four seconds has fewer occasions to practise sitting with not-knowing. The foundational years are where we teach children that not-knowing is the beginning of thinking, rather than a failure of the search bar.

THE FOUNDATION, IN FOUR PARTS

- Read with understanding - not merely decode words
- Reason with numbers - not merely perform procedures
- Write with clarity - the discipline that reveals muddled thinking
- Sit with difficulty - the stamina every later success is built on

CSAP

The Future of Aspirants' Dreams

The Civil Services Aspirant Programme plants the seed of public service long before the first coaching class – and asks a question most schools never do.

BY THE GENZ TIMES CAREERS DESK

Ask a room of Class VI students in any Indian city what they want to become and you will hear the same four answers. Doctor. Engineer. Cricketer. Actor. Ask them what an Indian Administrative Service officer actually does on a Tuesday morning and the room goes quiet – not because they are uninterested, but because nobody has ever told them.

This is the gap CSAP exists to close. The Civil Services Aspirant Programme is SLPL's structured attempt to answer an obvious question that Indian schooling has never seriously asked: why do most children discover the civil services at twenty-two, when the habits that clear the examination are formed at twelve? This is where CSAP finds a way to delve into the nuances of the civil-services examination by giving a limpid orientation and a flexible awareness.

AWARENESS IS NOT PRESSURE

The objection arrives immediately, and it deserves a straight answer. Is this not simply coaching, pushed earlier into childhood? No – and the distinction is the entire point of the programme. Coaching optimises a student for an examination. Awareness shows a student that a door exists.

How CSAP thinks: awareness, aptitude, alignment, action.

A twelve-year-old who knows that the district collector who visited her school is a person with a job she could one day hold has been given something. A twelve-year-old enrolled in a UPSC crash course has been given something else entirely, and it is not good for her.

WHAT THE PROGRAMME ACTUALLY TEACHES

Strip away the branding and CSAP teaches four things, none of which are exotic. It teaches students to read a newspaper properly – which is to say, to distinguish an event from an opinion about an event. It teaches them to write a short argument that holds together. It teaches them the architecture of their own government. And it teaches them that public service is a career, not a fantasy.

That is a modest ambition, honestly stated. It is also, for the students it reaches, an entire life.

WHAT CSAP ACTUALLY BUILDS

- Awareness of what public-service careers are, beyond the myths and the uniform.
- The reading, reasoning and writing habits that quietly decide every competitive outcome.
- A school-friendly roadmap from Grade 6 onward – early enough to matter, calm enough to keep.
- Skills that serve the student for life, whichever career she finally chooses.

“The UPSC is not cleared in a coaching centre at twenty-two. It is quietly won in a library at twelve.”

CSAP PHILOSOPHY

Every one of those four skills is useful to a student who never sits the civil services examination at all. That is the test of a good programme: it should leave a child better off even if she chooses a completely different life.

THE HONEST LIMIT

CSAP will not manufacture officers. Nothing can, and any programme that claims otherwise is selling something. What it can do is ensure that when a capable student from a school with no tradition of public service discovers, at nineteen, that she wants to serve, she is not starting seven years behind a classmate whose father happened to be in the department.

How CSAP thinks

- 1 Awareness**
what the services actually are, beyond the myths and the uniform
- 2 Aptitude**
the reading, reasoning and writing habits that quietly decide outcomes
- 3 Alignment**
matching a student's real strengths to a real service
- 4 Action**
a school-friendly roadmap from Grade 6 onward, without the panic

SKILL OF THE ISSUE

Prompt Engineering

The most valuable new literacy is not coding. It is asking. A practical guide, built around a real task: designing a CSAP module from scratch.

BY THE GENZ TIMES SKILLS DESK

A prompt is an instruction given to an artificial intelligence. A good prompt is a brief. The difference between the two is the difference between walking into an architect's office and saying build me something nice, and walking in with a plot size, a budget, a family of four and a preference for morning light.

Both are requests. Only one will get you a house you want to live in. And yet the overwhelming majority of people using AI today are still saying build me something nice, and then concluding that the architect is stupid.

THE R-T-C-F FRAMEWORK

Almost every good prompt contains four elements. Give the model a Role, so it knows whose expertise to imitate. Give it a Task, stated as a verb. Give it Context - the constraints that make your situation yours and not somebody else's. And specify a Format, so the answer arrives in a shape you can actually use.

The R-T-C-F framework

- 1 Role**
You are a curriculum designer for Indian middle-school students.
- 2 Task**
Design a six-week CSAP civic-awareness module.
- 3 Context**
Grade 6. Forty-minute periods. No prior civics. Mixed reading levels.
- 4 Format**
A week-by-week table: objective, one activity, one short reading.

The R-T-C-F framework: Role, Task, Context, Format.

Paste those four lines into any competent AI assistant and you will get, in under a minute, a serviceable draft of a six-week module. It will not be finished. It will be a first draft that a thoughtful

teacher can argue with - which is exactly what you want, because arguing with a draft is enormously faster than staring at a blank page.

ITERATION IS THE WHOLE SKILL

The beginners stop there. The people who get real value keep going. Make week three more hands-on. Add an assessment rubric. The reading for week two is too hard for a mixed-ability class - give me three versions at different levels. Now find the weakest assumption in this module and tell me why it might fail.

That last prompt is the one almost nobody uses, and it is the most valuable of all. An AI asked to praise your work will praise it. An AI asked to attack your work will find the crack you were avoiding.

"An AI asked to praise your work will praise it. An AI asked to attack your work will find the crack you were avoiding."

ON PROMPTING WELL

WHERE PROMPTING STOPS

None of this makes the machine wise. It cannot know that your Class VI has a child who has stopped speaking since her father died, or that the last activity you tried collapsed because the room has no power point. Prompting well gets you a strong draft at extraordinary speed. Judgement - the deciding of what is actually right for these children, in this room, this week - remains stubbornly, permanently yours.

THE FOUR FAILURES OF A BAD PROMPT

Almost every disappointing answer traces back to one of four omissions. The prompt gave no role, so the model answered like a search engine. It gave no context, so the answer was generic

and could have been written for anybody. It asked for too many things at once, so the model did all of them shallowly. Or it accepted the first draft, which is the most common failure of all and the easiest to fix.

There is a fifth, subtler failure that afflicts good students in particular: asking the AI a question you should have sat with yourself. A model will happily hand you a thesis statement. It will not hand you the twenty minutes of confusion in which you would have discovered what you actually think.

TRY IT THIS WEEK

- Write one prompt using all four parts: Role, Task, Context, Format
- Then iterate at least three times - never accept the first answer
- Ask the model to find the weakest assumption in its own output
- Verify every fact. A confident AI is not a correct AI.

BEHIND THE BUILD

Programming the CSAP

Turning a good idea into a repeatable system. Why a programme is a different animal from a lesson - and why the difference decides whether it survives.

BY THE GENZ TIMES EDITORIAL DESK

A brilliant teacher can improvise. She can walk into a room with nothing prepared, read the mood, and deliver forty minutes that a student remembers for thirty years. This is a real and precious thing, and it is also the reason so much of Indian education quietly fails: because it cannot be copied.

From Step 1 to Step 5, CSAP guides students through a structured journey of curiosity, concepts, analysis, application and preparation. A programme is the opposite of improvisation. It is the deliberate attempt to make quality independent of who happens to be standing in the room. That is a lower ceiling and a much, much higher floor - and across ten thousand classrooms, the floor is what matters.

WHAT A MODULE MUST CARRY

Every CSAP module is built to the same specification, because consistency is the point. One objective, stated so precisely that a teacher can tell within forty minutes whether it was met. One activity that a teacher with no special training can actually run. One short reading. One reflection prompt that forces the student to write, because writing is where vague opinions go to die.



A programme designed for the student in front of you, not an average that fits nobody.

Notice what is missing from that list: brilliance. A module is not trying to be brilliant. It is trying to be reliably good in the hands of a tired teacher on a Thursday afternoon in a school with no projector. Design for that teacher and you have designed for everyone.

A CHANGE FROM ROUTINE

Ordinary civics teaches facts about government: the number of members in the Rajya Sabha, the powers of a governor, the stages of a bill. Students memorise them, reproduce them, and forget them within a fortnight, having formed no relationship whatever with the institution described.

CSAP inverts this. It begins with a problem the student can see from her own window - a broken road, an unlit street, a school without a library - and works backwards to the office responsible for it. The Rajya Sabha becomes memorable not because it was on the syllabus but because it is upstream of something the student cares about.

“Ordinary civics teaches facts about the government. CSAP teaches a relationship with it - the sense that the state is something you can join, shape and serve.”

ON THE CSAP METHOD

BRIEFING THE TEACHER

A module is only as good as the briefing that accompanies it. The most common way programmes die in Indian schools is not rejection but dilution: the material arrives, the teacher is handed a folder in the staff room, and by week three the module has quietly reverted to a lecture because nobody explained what it was for.

CSAP briefings therefore spend as much time on why as on what. A

teacher who understands that the point of the street-corner exercise is to make the machinery of government feel local will run it well even when the printed instructions do not anticipate her classroom. A teacher who has only been handed the instructions will abandon them the first time reality departs from the page.

THE UNGLAMOROUS TRUTH

Building a programme is mostly tedious. It is writing the same objective eleven times until it is unambiguous. It is testing an activity in four classrooms and watching three of them go wrong. It is the deeply unfashionable work of making something that does not need you in order to succeed - which is, when you think about it, a fairly good description of teaching itself.

CAREER AWARENESS

From CETs to the UPSC

One habit of preparation, many destinations. The skills that clear a state entrance test are the same ones that clear the civil services – and almost nobody tells students this.

BY THE GENZ TIMES CAREERS DESK

Indian students prepare for examinations the way a traveller might pack for each leg of a journey separately – a new suitcase for every city, nothing reused, everything bought again. They prepare for the board examination. Then, separately, for a state common entrance test. Then, separately again, for a national entrance. Then, years later, exhaustedly, for the civil services.

What almost nobody tells them is that the suitcases contain very largely the same clothes. Reading comprehension. Logical reasoning. Data interpretation. Clear written argument. These four skills are the shared currency of nearly every competitive examination India offers, and a student who builds them properly once has, without quite realising it, prepared for most of them.

WHY AWARENESS IS THE NEED OF THE HOUR

The cost of not knowing this is enormous, and it is paid mostly by students from families with no examination tradition. A child whose uncle cleared the UPSC absorbs the strategy at the dinner table. A child from a household where nobody has sat a competitive examination discovers the strategy in her third year of college, having spent six years preparing in the least efficient way available.

A five-step readiness formula

- 1 **Diagnose**
map the student's real level, not the class she is sitting in
- 2 **Build the base**
reading, reasoning, numeracy and written argument
- 3 **Add exam-craft**
patterns, timing, and a working sense of negative marking
- 4 **Mock and measure**
full-length tests under genuinely real conditions
- 5 **Review the miss**
every wrong answer is information, not a verdict

A five-step readiness formula: diagnose, build the base, add exam-craft, mock and measure, review the miss.

THE OBJECTIVE AND THE OUTCOME

The objective is not a rank. The objective is optionality – the condition of having more than one door open at eighteen. A student who has built the four core skills can sit a CET, a law entrance, a defence examination or a banking test without starting over, and can change her mind at twenty without having wasted the previous four years.

“The objective is not a rank. The objective is optionality – the condition of having more than one door open at eighteen.”

GENZ TIMES EDITORIAL

TEST READINESS IS A SEPARATE SKILL

Knowing the material and performing under examination conditions are different competencies, and the second is

trainable. Mock tests build stamina rather than knowledge: the capacity to remain analytical in the ninety-first minute, to abandon a question that is devouring time, to survive the moment in the second section when everything suddenly feels unfamiliar.

This is why the review matters more than the score. A student who scores forty and understands precisely why she lost the other sixty has learned more than a student who scored seventy and has no idea how.

MULTIPLE BENEFITS, ONE FOUNDATION

- One preparation opens CETs, entrances, defence, banking and the UPSC
- Confidence compounds across examinations rather than resetting
- Early clarity on genuine strengths, before the choices narrow
- Schools can deliver this at scale – it does not require coaching



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PLATFORM

SchoolCast: A School On Air

SL Radio gives a school its own private radio station - and, beside it, an evaluation system that finally measures what a mark cannot.

BY THE GENZ TIMES EDITORIAL
DESK • BUILT BY THE SLPL
ENGINEERING TEAM

A school speaks to itself constantly - morning announcements, news, talks, results, event notices - but the tools for it are poor. A wired public-address system reaches only the rooms it is wired to, cannot be heard at home, and keeps no record. Commercial streaming apps are public, advertisement-driven and unsafe to hand to children. SchoolCast, built on SL Radio, is the answer: a communication network a school actually owns.

A student or teacher speaks into a microphone on a dedicated broadcasting PC, and the audio streams live to every listener in the school community - on an Android phone, a computer, or any web browser. Every broadcast is recorded automatically and kept for a week, so nothing is ever missed. The app is fully translated into English, Telugu and Hindi, plays in the background, and carries no advertisements at all.



The listener app: choose your school, enter the access code once, and tune in.

PRIVATE BY CONSTRUCTION

Each school is a self-contained appliance. The broadcasting PC runs the whole stack and publishes over a secure tunnel; no audio is relayed through a central server, so one school's broadcast never touches another's and the school owns its own data. It is closed by an access code, moderated, and safe for minors by design.



The Station Console: live logs, scheduling, broadcast control and chat moderation - run by a student, no technical skill required.

"A wired PA system reaches the rooms it is wired to. SchoolCast reaches the child at home - and remembers everything it said."

ON SL RADIO

THE OTHER HALF: EVALUATION & RUBRICS

A school communication network solves the problem of being heard. The harder problem is being measured. This is the second half of the platform: the School Evaluation System, which replaces the single, blunt examination mark with a rubric - a structured set of criteria that says, specifically, what good looks like and where this particular child currently stands against it.

A mark of thirty-four tells a student she failed. A rubric tells her that her argument was strong, her evidence thin and her structure absent - the difference between a verdict and a map. The two systems reinforce each other: the radio makes the school audible, the rubric makes the learning legible.

WHAT THE PLATFORM DELIVERS

- A private, self-hosted radio station per school - app, desktop and browser listeners
- Live chat, a broadcast schedule, and a one-week automatic archive
- Trilingual (English, Telugu, Hindi), background playback, zero advertisements
- A rubric-based School Evaluation System - measuring what a single mark cannot